

Swaraag Sistla

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EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

Expected Jun. 2029

Computer Science, B.S.: Donald Bren School of ICS | GPA: 3.94, Dean's Honor List (all quarters)

- Completed Coursework: Discrete Math for CS; Python Programming and Libraries; Intro to Linear Algebra; Programming in C/C++ as a Second Language; Intro to Software Engineering

AI SAFETY

AI Safety Research

Jun. 2026 – Present

Independent Researcher | [Neural Eval GitHub](#)

Sammamish, WA

- Developing a causal interpretability method to measure whether LLMs run their reasoning circuits when memorized answers suffice, a question that determines to what extent current capability benchmarks can be trusted.
- Worked towards designing the first dangerous-capability benchmark evaluating frontier LLM behavior on neural data with respect to cognitive and personal privacy.

AI Safety Collective at Irvine

Apr. 2026 – Present

Co-Director - Project Incubator Lead

Irvine, CA

- Helping direct and implement AI Safety initiatives out of UC Irvine. Developing a plan for running technical research projects by the club and its members in the Fall; structurally overhauling the club's design for the coming year.

EXPERIENCE

Mu Sigma

Jul. 2026 – Present

Intern

Remote

- Building an end-to-end analytics product for a Fortune 25 client, attributing warehouse damage events to root cause and surfacing dwell exceptions across thousands of active work orders.

Pierre Baldi Lab

Feb. 2026 – Apr. 2026

Undergraduate Researcher, UC Irvine

Irvine, CA

- Developed and benchmarked deep learning architectures for reactive atom prediction in polar organic reaction mechanisms, under Prof. Pierre Baldi and Ryan Miller, using Python, PyTorch, RDKit & OpenEye.
- Achieved a 9.2 percentage point improvement in end-to-end top-1 reaction mechanism prediction accuracy over the JACS 2025 published baseline (55.6% to 64.8%) through Graph Transformer-based atom scoring.

Exoplanet Classification

Feb. 2026 – Mar. 2026

Independent ML Research | [GitHub](#) | [Paper](#)

Remote

- Trained and compared Random Forest and XGBoost classifiers on the NASA Kepler Objects of Interest catalog to automate exoplanet candidate vetting, with XGBoost achieving ROC-AUC of 0.986 and nearly halving missed planets relative to Random Forest (28 vs. 53 false negatives).
- Applied SHAP analysis to connect learned feature importances to underlying astrophysics, and generated a prioritized list of 394 high-confidence planet candidates from 1,979 unresolved KOIs for radial velocity follow-up.

Earth and Space Research

Jul. 2023 – Oct. 2024

Climate Data Science Researcher | [Antarctic Blog](#) & [Poster](#) | [Greenland Blog](#) & [Abstract](#)

Seattle, WA

- Performed Antarctic climate research: leveraged ML methods (multivariate regression, time series analysis) to identify anomaly correlations between air temperature and sea ice averages over the last 30 years.
- Analyzed variable correlations within open-source Greenland data from NOAA; compiled a report for the research institute. Discovered and reported a major inaccuracy in NOAA's relative humidity data; proved my case with statistical features coupled with thermodynamic modeling.
- Presented an Antarctic summarizing poster to the University of Washington Glaciology faculty & grad students; wrote school and Greenland blogs.

Ice Kitchen Ltd.

Aug. 2023 – Dec. 2024

Researcher | [Paper](#) | [Poster](#)

Remote

- Used ML (KNN, random forest) to analyze correlations between 97 companies' sales & weather data.
- Produced a report for Ice Kitchen comparing their sales-weather correlations with competitors' data; presented findings and wrote a detailed research report on process, results, and discussion.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, Swift, C/C++, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Tools: React, React Native, FastAPI, Node.js, Expo, Colyseus, Git

ML & Data Science: PyTorch, NumPy, pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, scikit-learn, RDKit, OpenEye

AI & Tooling: Prompt Engineering, Agentic Workflows, Claude Code, MCP